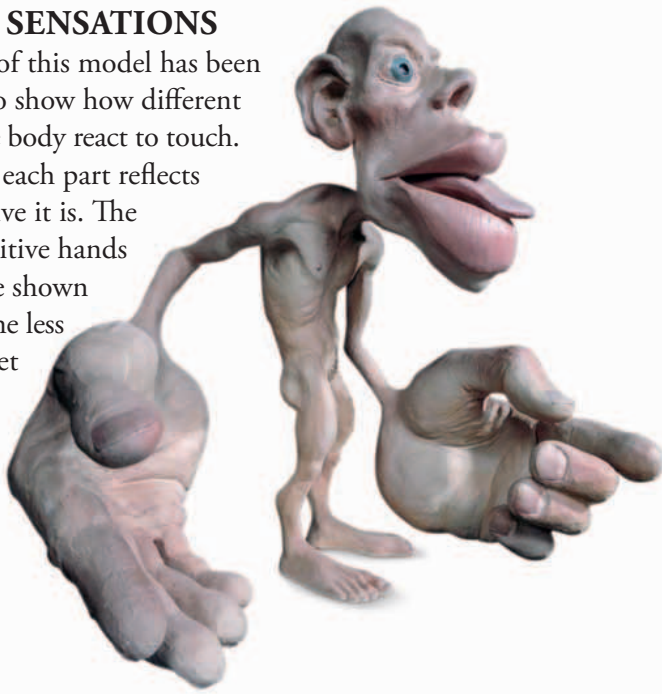


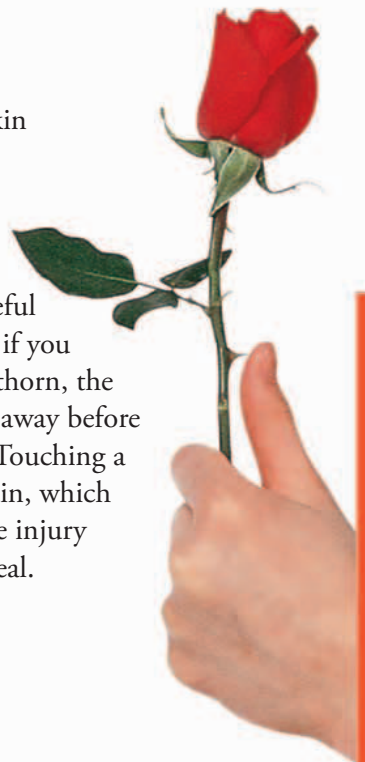
TOUCH SENSATIONS

The shape of this model has been distorted to show how different parts of the body react to touch. The size of each part reflects how sensitive it is. The highly sensitive hands and lips are shown large and the less sensitive feet are small.



FEELING PAIN

Some nerves in your skin (and in other parts of your body) react to physical injury by generating pain. This is unpleasant, but a useful warning. For example, if you prick your finger on a thorn, the pain makes you pull it away before you do more damage. Touching a tender bruise causes pain, which teaches you to leave the injury alone and allow it to heal.

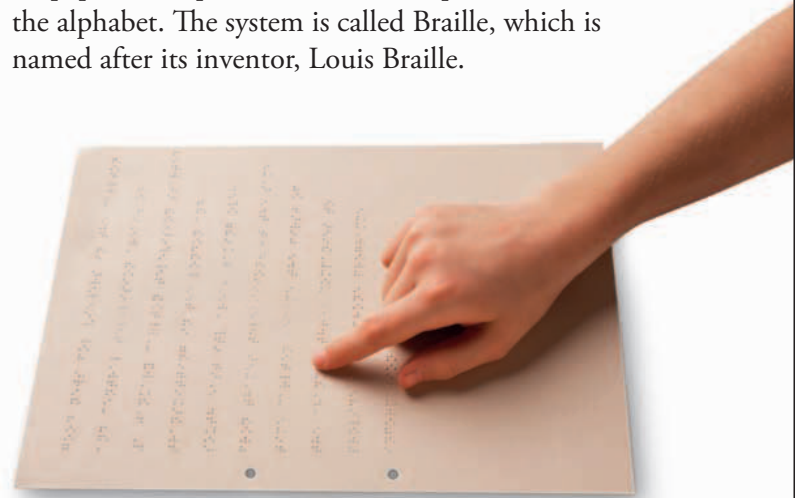


COLD COMFORT

Have you ever hurt yourself and not noticed, because you were enjoying yourself too much? This shows how your mind can affect your sense of pain. Doctors have been able to help people with severe burns take their minds off the pain by getting them to play virtual reality games set in cold, snowy places!

TRACING THE DOTS

Your sensitive fingertips can pick up the slightest differences in the feel of an object. A blind person can use touch to read, by feeling the patterns of raised dots on paper. Each pattern stands for a specific letter of the alphabet. The system is called Braille, which is named after its inventor, Louis Braille.



Light pressure



Heat and cold



Deep pressure



Faint touch



Stretching